

FADE IN:

INT: FLORIDIAN MANSION - AFTERNOON

14-year-old Damian Andrés sits on his family couch in one of the living rooms looking down at the tablet in his hands. He is wearing white circular in-ear earbuds, nodding to an unheard song, and is tapping methodically on the screen. The couch isn't discernable by any means, matted grey with a beautiful sewn pattern. The living room is huge, with 4 fabric chairs, 3 large couches, a blazing fireplace, a stairway leading to a higher level, and 6 large windows exposing the proximity of the ocean. The mansion sits off the coast of the Golf in Naples. It's distinct beige coat and maroon roofing is beloved by most of the community. Within the home itself, loud shuffling, the shuttering of cameras, and blow dryers can be heard. The sun is beginning to set.

Damian breathes deep suddenly, pauses the game, and folds his tablet twice. His music reacts by lowering in volume. On the new tablet screen, he proceeds to check the time.

-4:21 PM-

DAMIAN

(Angrily) Jesus! He's always like this.

Damian clicks the phone off in frustration. Thanks to the chandelier above him, he notices his reflection in the black void of the screen. Curly brown hair that always slicks to one side in the morning, dark brown eyes, sharp thick eyebrows, tan skin, no visible blemishes or acne.

DAMIAN

(in a less aggressive, but still angry tone) This stupid face is never gonna change is it? That woman will use me to the day I die.

MALE VOICE

(In a distant muffled volume) ... live in 15 Rosa!

He sighs, realizing in a few minutes his mother's show would be starting. He turns around burying his knees into the couch to stare out the front driveway, yearning for something to appear.

A beat.

BING.

Damian's tablet comes to life on the couch. The bubbled text: (AQUI) can be read.

Damian's face lights up immensely. No name was attached to the text, just a string of numbers. All the same, Damian jumps up, pockets his iTab, and dramatically strolls to door. His stride resembles someone bouncing to an unheard song. **Crackles** coming from the fireplace inject a scent of fresh pinewood into the home.

DAMIAN
(to no one) Hey Carolina!

The corners of the living room ignite in a blue hue. Damian continues to bounce walk.

CAROLINA THE AI
(from an undisclosed location) Yes,
Damian?

Carolina's sweet Spanish accent, like a loving mother, seemingly brightens the room.

DAMIAN
(toward the ceiling) My brother is
here! You know what that means!

CAROLINA
(after a few moments) Oh, it means
I'll have to go. Terminating
outsourcing of data.

Carolina's blue hue breathes off and on, reflecting her completing her task.

CAROLINA
(longingly) That boy, I remember the
days where we played hide and seek
together. Of course I always knew
where he was hiding per my protocol,
pero...

DAMIAN
(bothered) Titi Carolina, you're
rambling again.

CAROLINA
Ah, apologies! Have a nice visit with
Julian. Damian, quieres something to

drink before I go?

DAMIAN

(Loudly) That won't be necessary!
(quietly) just leave already...

CAROLINA

(sweetly) Hasta Luego, sweetie.

A loud **BEEP** echos throughout the house. The blazing fireplace quiets down to a dull smolder until it dissipates. The noise of jittery employees and a barking woman coming from the other half of the home pause for a moment. They continue a few seconds later. Damian steps in front of the grand entrance doors, smiling at the disruption he had just caused.

Damian grabs the front door handle and pulls, not questioning if his brother was there or not. He was.

Twenty-two-year-old Julian Andrés stands firmly at the front door across from his brother. By his facial expression and demeanor, he appears as if he is lost. He stands much taller than Damian, around 6'2" in baggy beige joggers, a blank sweatshirt and muddy worn sneakers. If Damian were taller, the two would be almost identical beside some light scarring on Julian's forehead and left cheek. Damian smiles as he looks up and down Julian.

DAMIAN

(almost yelling) Mom's gonna go insane
when she looks at what you're wearing!
Dios Mio!

JULIAN

(In a deep confident voice, also
smiling) Here's hoping.

Damian runs toward Julian embracing his torso. Julian smiles back and quickly embraces his brother. Damian buries the side of his face into his brother's chest.

JULIAN

(Putting his hand on Damian's head)
You got taller.

DAMIAN

(smiling) I missed you so...

Damian jumps back from his brother, coughing slightly and lowering his smile to just a slight smirk. He appears

embarrassed by the amount of affection he was giving.

Julian chuckles at his awkward brother. Damian lightly punches Julian's chest repeatedly.

DAMIAN

(while still punching Julian) How was the drive? How's boxing? Did you hear about the snow tonight? Have you been in any earthquakes? I heard they were some in Cali. But then again, UCLA is like its own ecosystem so who knows what you went through. How are the girls?!

JULIAN

Exhausting. Difficult. Yeah, it's really cold here. Yes, those were scary. And beautiful. But I'm too busy for anything serious.

Damian stops "attacking" his brother.

DAMIAN

Come onnnnnnn, hermano. You're joking.

JULIAN

Nope. (A Beat) How ya been?

Damian puts his hands in his pockets.

DAMIAN

Well, ya sabes. Days have been... meh. Mom's being herself. I've been on break for the past few days. My grades are good...

JULIAN

Uh-huh.

DAMIAN

Still looking for that perfect someone. Got honeys lining up left and right, you know how I be.

Julian looks knowingly at his brother.

DAMIAN

Ah, not the eyes... Alright alright. (admittedly) I've been alone a lot.

I've had trouble making friends at that new boarding school. All the guys seem to resent me and all the girls I know just ask about you so... I kinda just do nothing and fuck around. When I'm not on air anyway

JULIAN

(smirking) Did you do that thing I told you, to get attention?

DAMIAN

(smiling) You mean did I go and punch the biggest guy in the school??

They both laugh.

DAMIAN

School is basically prison so you're right in that sense. Hmm. The biggest guy in my school is Principal Ripley. And he's more round than big. Pero, I don't know. Mom would beat my ass if I even dreamed of doing anything like that.

Julian nods.

JULIAN

(frustrated) Ugh, I can't even do anything! All these stupid cameras around following me! Even the dang security officers at the school hate me.

JULIAN

Hm.

DAMIAN

(shaking his head) Anyway, did I mention how it's gonna snow today?

JULIAN

Yep, exciting.

Julian looks around for his keys. A beat.

JULIAN

He's not here, right?

DAMIAN

Nah, I haven't seen him since the trial... (quietly) I barely think about him anymore.

JULIAN

(sighing) Having control over your own life is well worth a few broken bones and burnt bridges. I did what I had to do for the both of us. Once you're 18, mom can't so much as even point a polaroid at you without your consent. And don't worry, if she beats your ass, I'll protect ya.(turning around and yelling) You got everything?!

Damian smiles. He then moves his head to look beyond Julian. He sees Julian's car parked in the driveway, a mustard yellow Tesla with a raised trunk. It appeared as worn as Julian himself. Wind can be heard and a slight chill rings through the air. The trunk slowly lowers and appearing out from behind the car is Julian's childhood friend Jacob Cassius. Besides being the same age and growing up in the same city, Jacob and Julian were complete opposites in regard to physicality. Jacob is very round in physique, has dirty blonde hair, and light blue eyes. He is wearing a designer shearling jacket, pants, and sneakers and is lugging two medium-sized suitcases behind him. He approaches the two brothers after some time.

JACOB

(In fake desperate gasps) Kid! (he swallows) Oh, thank god!

Jacob drops the bags as he steps onto the one-step porch and tears Damian away from Julian, pushing him a few steps into the house. Jacob kneels to talk to Damian.

JACOB

(whispering to Damian but still loud enough so Julian can hear) So me and Julie here are gonna make you the tiebreaker in our argument. Better anime: Naruto or...

Jacob exaggeratively stands, turns to looks at Julian, smiles at him with mouth open and eyes shut, and turns and kneels back down to Damian.

JACOB

(still whispering loudly) Vinland Saga? I personally think V.S. has the edge but truth be told I've barely watched either. Julie's got too much time on his hands and he's definitely gained a pound a two. I think we should both tell him together...-

Jacob waits for Damian to respond.

JACOB

-slow down on the Twinkies! I can not bear to see him wash away that boxing scholarship of his in a sea of calories.

Damian starts to laugh. Julian picks up the two suitcases and walks into the house.

JULIAN

Har-Har.

Julian closes the door behind him. Jacob stands up smiling and looks around. Julian continues down through the room, nearing the stairs.

JACOB

Man, I haven't been here in ages. 2 years. (he whistles) Still smells of burnt hair, palm trees, and the loss of childhood. (to Damian) How ya been D? Still in that boarding school in New Zealand?

DAMIAN

(rolling his eyes) New Hampshire, pendejo.

JACOB

(gasping loudly) Julie! Julie! (in low volume a cry voice) He's grown!

JULIAN

(sighing) Enough with the jokes. We gotta say hi to you know who.

Jacob loses a bit of his smile. His clothing and shearling jacket fit well with the room. Damian's smirk fades. It appears they both know of something unsaid. Julian lets go of the suitcases, leaving them by one of the nearby couch

chairs. He begins his ascent, leading the boys through the house. After the three walk up a large set of stairs, they enter a hallway plastered with family photos. Both Julian and Damian walk ahead onto the carpet ignoring the photos, while Jacob carries a smirk.

JACOB

2.4 acres and you'd think they spread these photos around... Remind me to talk to your guy's interior decorator. Woah, haven't seen this one before. (examining the photo) I mean, what is this?

Jacob points at a particularly noticeable photo situated on the beige wall. The photo shows Julian and a bearded well dressed older Hispanic male standing next to him in front of a white with black spot background. His white button-down and black slacks contrasted heavily the woman laying across the floor's black leopard outfit. She was laying on a pink fuzzy carpet. The two males stood uncomfortable.

JACOB

(as if announcing a wrestler) Ladies and Gentleman, the controlling, the brutal, the life sucking, Rosa Andrés!

FADE IN:

Int. Ander's Mansion Study

Rosa Andrés, 39, looks directly into a camera. She is of beautiful physique, tall and powerful. She has tan skin. long silky black hair, and is wearing a red dress that kisses her knees. She is barefoot and is sitting within her personal study. Pictures of the Andrés family almost surround her. Her thick Dominican accent fills the room. Around her are her 2 beauticians and a cameraman.

ROSA

(strongly) How much longer, Roman? Son las 4:59.

ROMAN THE CAMERAMAN

(sincerely) Everything's set Senora Andrés, I'm just having trouble connecting to the wifi.

BEAUTICIAN 1

(smiling as she brings a mirror to

Rosa) Gorgeous as always Rosa.

ROSA

(dismissing) I'll take your word for it. (worried) Oh, I like to hear Carolina's voice before I go on. The night usually doesn't go well when I don't. But she won't respond to me.

Rosa takes a deep breath.

ROSA

(wagging her finger) There better not be a repeat of the mascara fiasco.

BEAUTICIAN 2

(nodding) Remember Rosa, the president himself invited you for dinner tomor-

Footsteps can be heard outside the door.

ROSA

(gasps) Pienso que mi hijo esta en la casa. Start the trend "Unidos Por Fin," on Twitter. We can't get any shots of Julian per say, but we can still talk about what I'm doing, even if he's around, no?

Rosa laughs proudly as if overcoming a great foe. Her employees chuckle slightly, more out of obligation than sincerity. The study is of modest size, with large bookcases lined on either side of the room and one large window right behind Rosa. In front of her and the camera lies the entrance. It opens, revealing Julian with Jacob and Damian trailing.

ROSA

(Loudly) AY! Oh, my baby has come home to me!

Rosa leaps out of the chair heading toward the door. Her smile wavers, after she sees what he's wearing.

ROSA

TWO whole years I haven't seen this beautiful face in person. (she extends her arms toward Julian's face). It kills me -

JULIAN
(sternly, blocking her from touching him) The cameras have to be off Ma.
The judge...

Rosa analyzes her son.

ROSA
(in an upset tone) Ay, you haven't seen me in dos años, you arrive in horrible attire, and you have nothing else to say but, "the cameras, the cameras?"

Rosa picks at his clothes, staring at them. Julian continues looking at her. She looks back up to him.

ROSA
(sighing) Well, they are. Can I get a hug?

A beat.

The room remains silent in the exchange. Rosa's employees are locked onto their iGlasses, seemingly attempting to ignore the pause in the exchange.

JACOB
(Abruptly) You can get one from me, Mama!

ROSA
(looking behind Julian) Dios Mio, out of all the beautiful women in California, you bring me back the Pillsbury Doughboy?! (she smiles at Damian)

Jacob pushes past the two with open arms.

JACOB
And like the Pillsbury doughboy, I'm loveable, delectable, and marriable.

ROSA
No one has ever married that character, Jacob.

Rosa nods, seemingly approving of Jacob's outfit. The two hug.

JACOB
(breaking the hug) How bout we change
that?

Jacob grabs Rosa's left hand and places his right on her hip.
He dances with her and she goes along with it, laughing.

JULIAN
We have to go Jacob, to the attic,
remember?

JACOB
What's two more minutes with the love
of my life, huh Julian?

He continues waltzing with Rosa, grazing a few items like the
camera and beauty supplies with his back. The crew develop
annoyed faces.

JULIAN
We have something to finish. She has
to get back to her show anyway.

Jacob stops dancing as if the phrase was a secret sleeper
phrase. He lets go of Rosa's hands.

JACOB
I missed ya, Rosa. Thanks for the
dance. *Rosa's Casa* was funny last
night. (whispering in her ear) But
definitely fire your employee for that
eyeliner mishap.

He turns and begins to walk out. Rosa turns angrily to her
beautician's and breaths deeply, knowing she would follow the
advice of a loyal fan. She turns back to Jacob.

ROSA
Ah, don't worry about that, mistakes
happen. I want pictures later Julian,
ah? Your father should be home later
this week!

Jacob walks back outside. Julian begins to close the door.
Rosa grabs its edge

ROSA
(demandingly) Disculpame, ninos?

The three freeze, Julian looks away frustrated and wanting

the interaction to end.

ROSA

Tonight's a very important moment for me and my career and not one of you give me a "Bueno Suerte," or a kiss on the cheek? I'm discussing the health care with the President of the United St-

Julian closed the door, interrupting her sentence. He stood in the hallway staring into the distance. Damian looks at his brother, a slight smirk appears on Damian's face.

JULIAN

(exhaling out, regaining composure)
Enough with the fake shit. Let's head to the attic, we got work to do.

FADE IN:

INT: PARKED DEPUTY SHERIFF'S CAR OUTSIDE GAS STATION

Officer Hale sits alone in a white police car parked at a Bucc-EE's Daily gas station. Night envelopes the sky. The car is dark as the engine is off, but the large yellow shell sign lights up the car better than the moon. Hale Matthews, 32, wears a blonde buzz cut as good as anyone can. He's of medium-thick build, sweating a good deal. His face is distracted, a bit upset, and a bit nervous. He's holding a bouquet of white lilies in one hand, latching his gun buckle on and off with the other. The gun that sits in the holster appears a bit rusted.

Hale looks at the clock on the dashboard, 7:22 pm, and fidgets as if there is somewhere he has to be.

He closes his eyes for a moment, looking up toward the roof of the car. He breathes, a deep sigh of relief takes over.

A beat.

HOMELESS HUGH

(Loud Snoring)

OFFICER HALE

(gripping his flowers) JESUS!

He turns. Behind Hale lays, belly up, an old bearded homeless caucasian male. He is cuffed with his arms to his back. His clothes are incredibly dirtied and tattered.

HOMELESS HUGH
(Loud Snoring)

BANG BANG BANG. Hale elbows strongly the gated barrier dividing Hale from Hugh.

OFFICER HALE
Cut it out!

Hugh jostles.

HOMELESS HUGH
(slurring) Fuuuuck man. (long drawn out sniff) P-Hughhhh, someones gotta - (he looks to Hale) You should be hitting the showers instead of that... metal... contrap - ception...

OFFICER HALE
(annoyed) Oh Jesus Hugh, every week we go through this shit. Please, not tonight.

Officer Hale continues to fidget with his gun buckle. **Click.** The driver's door opens. Enters Officer Diane Gale, 29. A well built, stout, white woman. Her frizzy brunette hair is untied, drooping down onto her shoulders. She enters the car and slams the door shut swiftly, turning to Hugh and then to Hale.

OFFICER DIANE
(mocking and laughing) What, big bad Hugh bothering you?

OFFICER HALE
(in a mocking tone) No, Dr. **Suess**, did **you** finish in the bathroom?

HOMELESS HUGH
(slurring) This is... a bathroom?

OFFICER HALE
(annoyed) Oh, what the fuck! You better not be pissing back there.

Hugh rests back down. Diane grabs as much of her own hair as she can and ties it into a bun. Despite her efforts, stragglers still dance around her face.

OFFICER DIANE
(fidgeting with the receiver) Any

calls?

OFFICER HALE

(slightly annoyed) We're in one of the wealthiest and most heavily policed parts of Florida and you're worried about calls?

Diane lifts a pair of translucent shield glasses docked patiently on the driver's dashboard. She puts them on methodically. She then begins looking ahead at something invisible. A faint glow emanates from the lenses. Miniscule images and texts can be seen floating throughout its frame.

OFFICER DIANE

(Half-Paying attention) Am I worried about us doing our job?
(sarcastically) No, definitely not.

OFFICER HALE

No, there haven't been any calls.
(sighs) We've been partners for 3 years-

OFFICER DIANE

Oh christ.

OFFICER HALE

-And I think we should both know a graveyard shift when we see one.

Hugh turns his body to the side, shifting the weight of the car.

OFFICER HALE

We're positioned here for one reason and one reason only.

Diane turns to Hale. Her face remains dead as if she already knows what the answer is, but is too bothered to say it. Hale doesn't even look to her, talking to himself.

OFFICER HALE

This damn C&D. Judge Danvers ordered us to go around this time, at the end of her special with the president. We're supposed to arrive a minute before the end of her episode? With the siren on? With an order usually delivered by lawyers?

OFFICER DIANE

Come on Hale. You know if it's not us,
it'll be a different unit. You of all
people should know Rosa already.

Officer Hale fidgets once more with his gun clip. A beat.

OFFICER DIANE

Those were in the trunk weren't they?
(still looking ahead) You gonna tell
me what the flowers are for?

Hale looks down at the lilies. They are a bit crinkled as
Hale's grip around them tightened and relaxed while the two
were talking. Now delicately holding on to them in the faint
light cast by the gas station sign, Hugh responds.

OFFICER HALE

I got someone to see.

OFFICER DIANE

In the middle of the night with your
partner? Oh no no no. You better tell
me they're for Hugh. You know, I can't
deal with men anymore. Especially
wound up ones like you.

Diane's looks steadily through her glasses.

OFFICER HALE

(Annoyed) I am not wound up!

OFFICER DIANE

(ignoring Hale) No way! I can't
believe it.

Diane's eyes begin to move rapidly, blinking in a chaotic but
methodical pattern. Hale motions toward the receiver.

OFFICER HALE

What? Is there a repor-

OFFICER DIANE

Julian's back from UCLA!

Hugh moves, seemingly in response to Diane's loudness.

OFFICER HALE

(sighing) Yeah, I heard.

OFFICER DIANE

You heard?! That's impossible, Rosa tweeted this a few hours ago! You don't have twitter.

Hale doesn't respond.

OFFICER DIANE

Wow. Haven't seen any images of the kid since the trials. Wonder what he looks like. Gosh, the kids like a young girls fantasy. I feel for him though. Fighting his own mother in court. And here we are, about deliver a C&D for some baby photos she post-

OFFICER HALE

I know what we're doing Diane, and we won't be able to do it if we don't start heading over there.

Diane shuts her eyes for a few seconds and then opens them. In response, her glasses dim and she places them back onto a dock on the dashboard.

OFFICER DIANE

Sheesh. Someone's upset tonight. If I didn't know any better, I'd say you were anxious. But-

She puts her right index finger to the car ignition, a sharp **BOOP** follows along with the start of the engine.

OFFICER DIANE

-in the words of Rosa herself, "Nunca corras toward the future, you'll never get what you like."

Diane mimicks Rosa's triumphant laugh. Hale looks ahead, seemingly somewhere else. The car pulls off the lot. As they do, a bell dings, telling its tale of another customer served.

FADE IN:

Int: Ander's Mansion

Julian, Jacob, and Damian walk down the main stairway and enter the living room. The boys' two suitcases, one black and one Supreme white and red, lay untouched. Julian looks to his analog watch, 5:15 pm. Julian turns to Jacob at the

foot of the stairs.

JULIAN

(sighing of relief) Glad that's over. You two should head to the attic. (he looks to Jacob) You should get things set up.

JACOB

Wait a god damn minute. We just drove an entire week, across the country, because of your fear of people, and the first thing we do is head to your cluttered attic?

JULIAN

Jacob, I don't have a fear of people. Do you want to get harassed on a plane?

JACOB

You mean adored and fawned over for my natural good looks and fame? HMMMMMM, if it's between that and a week-long cross-country trip in the middle of winter...

JULIAN

Listen, the faster we get this done, the quicker we can chill. It's also an important night for my kid brother.

Damian remains quiet, face inquisitive.

DAMIAN

So you guys just gonna act like I'm not here?

JULIAN

(with a slight grin) Lo siento hermano. I've been stuck with this guy for an entire week. His personality (using his hands to emphasize Jacob's size) takes up the whole room. I didn't notice you.

Damian and Julian begin to laugh.

JACOB

Har - har. Yeah, laugh at the fat

friend. Original!

JULIAN

I've been waiting on that one. Plus
you already made fun of me for my
twinkie addiction.

Jacob walks to the nearby kitchen: glamorous with beautiful
marble decor and an island countertop. He walks toward the
island, ducks down, and brings up a few shot glasses and a
bottle of hard liquor.

JULIAN

Ay ay, Seriously?

JACOB

What?

DAMIAN

How'd you even know where to -

JACOB

Your mother programmed that bot of
yours to keep the liquor accessible at
all times. I just picked up on it
while I was here.

JULIAN

(bothered) You can drink but I won't
have any. And neither will Damian.

JACOB

(pleading) Julie, you said it yourself
this is a special night for him.

JULIAN

Yeah an important night, not his
twenty-first birthday.

DAMIAN

Do I get a say in this?

JACOB

Of course, you do, we're all
consenting adults here. Plus with ol
Julie around, Rosa can't point the
cameras anywhere near you. No one will
see. She's busy anyway, talking to his
highness.

DAMIAN

You mean the President?

JACOB

Tomato Tomato, kid. You'll learn tonight.

JULIAN

Quit it, Jacob. He's not drinking.

Jacob, after placing the glasses on the table, pours one shot glasses full. Damian walks toward the island.

JULIAN

I have to head to my room and unpack somethings for tonight. It's best not done with cameras in the sky, even if they are "off." (Julian looks up toward the ceiling of the floor)

DAMIAN

You guys take all this stuff so seriously. All that stuff you sent me, the books and questions about-

Julian quickly quiets Damian by placing his hand on his brother's shoulder, squeezing tightly. A dead air fills the room. Damian appears shocked at his brother's serious attitude.

JULIAN

(locking eyes with Damian) Like I said, I'm going to my room. (he glances toward Jacob) He doesn't drink.

Julian moves his hand away from Damian. He fluidly grabs the glass, clanks it with Jacob's, walks toward the living room, grabs the suitcase, and walks up the stairs.

JACOB

You got it, boss.

DAMIAN

What is with you guys? (quietly) I mean por favor, I just thought this was some practical jo...ke.

Jacob knowingly looks at Damian.

DAMIAN

(sighs) Ay, okay okay. Jeez, you guys suck. Thought this was some elaborate late April fools.

JACOB

(scoffs) Word to the wise D. Your night and all the rest of them, are gonna be like no other from now on. And not in a good way.

DAMIAN

What do you-

Jacob slides Damian a glass half full of the old whiskey.

JACOB

Take this, you're gonna need it.

Damian places his hand on the glass and then looks behind him to see if his brother or his mother were lurking in anticipation. They weren't. He downs the entire glass looks at a smiling Jacob and retches.

DAMIAN

(half gagging) Oh shit, what the fu-

Boop Boop. The corners of the ceiling hum with a light blue light.

CAROLINA

(concerned) Damian! Estas tambien, what happened? I analyzed unusual coughing patterns as per my safety protocols. Oh! It looks like Julian and (sighing) the underachiever are here.

JACOB

(looking toward the ceiling smiling brightly) Hola, momma number two. Figured that would get a rise out of you. How you been?

CAROLINA

(slightly bothered) Jacob. It's been some time, hasn't it? Ugh! Enough of the pleasantries, Damian, do I need to take a blood test, administer CPR, call an ambulance?

JACOB

No! No. None of that will be necessary. Damian here just got chocked up from my college stories. Yeah, pretty gross, some of them.

CAROLINA

(knowingly) While I'm sure that that is true, I can obviously see a bottle of whiskey on the countertop.

A mechanical gear whirrs within the countertop, and a hole the size of a donut appears.

CAROLINA

Jacob, place the liquor in the slot. I'll have to reorganize the alcohol when you visit.

Damian gets a handle over himself and lifts his head from under the island.

DAMIAN

(raggedly) Carolina, Julian is home, you cannot be awake. Deactivate.

CAROLINA

But you're coug-

DAMIAN

(wheezing) Carolina! Do you want him to leave?

A beat.

CAROLINA

(sadly) Oh, alright. I just haven't seen him in so long. He looks so grown. Please, I won't make a sound! I'll deactivate all my lenses if I can just hear his voice...

DAMIAN

(clearing his throat) No. Do not make me force you off.

CAROLINA

(sadly) Ok, ok. Buenas Noche Damian. Do not continue to intoxicate yourself. It is dangerous for someone your age.

BEEP BOOP. The lights along the corners of the ceiling turn off.

JACOB

Didn't say good night to me! Rude.

DAMIAN

(with a clearer voice) You're the one who tried to access her personal software back during *La Vida* ...

JACOB

Hey, who told you that? That's a strategic lie to undermine my role in this family and I won't have any of it!

A beat.

JACOB

It was your mother, wasn't it?

Damian stands up, noticing the world and its new slight tilt.

DAMIAN

(ignoring Jacob) Come on, let's go to the stupid attic.

Jacob grabs a hold of Damian's shoulder.

DAMIAN

What now?

Jacob looks into Damian's eyes, asking him to follow his lead. Damian looks confused. Jacob heads toward the basement door, Damian follows.

FADE IN:

Int: Damian's Bedroom

Damian stands tall at his open bedroom door, his blank grey sweatshirt puffed as his chest expands from a deep breath. He grips his suitcase in one hand. Light emanating from the hallway behind him clashes with what's in front of him. It is an incredibly dark room. In direct contrast to the rest of the house, the walls are painted a faded gray, almost presumed black. They are plastered with a few pairs of boxing gloves, awards, and 3 different types of posters of Damian as a child with a bright smile, either clinging onto

his mother's arm or standing proudly surrounded by other kids. The titles of these posters ranged from, "*Una Vida Es Un Carnival*", *Julian Unmasked*, and, *Rosa's Casa*. Julian stares at each of them intently, before moving onto the rest of his room.

A king-sized bed with a black frame lay at the opposing end of the room across from Julian. The bed was prepared as if they had been in long wait. A window above the frame was also open, revealing a pool and the setting sun.

JULIAN

(under his breath) Do I miss it?

He takes a step in, closing the door behind him. Dusklight is the only light shining into the room.

JULIAN

(normal) Or do I hate it?

He walks toward his bed, lifting a seemingly empty suitcase. Standing at the foot of the bed, he looks around. Ignoring the surplus of gadgets, fan mail from teenagers, it is an average boy's room. In a corner lay a dusty old record player and a stack of vinyl. He hesitated in walking toward the bunch. Making out the album on top, was the Pink Floyd Album, *The Wall*. Julian snickered, noticing an invisible irony.

JULIAN

(to himself) I don't know sometimes.

But this doesn't matter anymore.

(under his breath) this isn't about me anymore. Time to be bigger than me.

Julian lifts the suitcase, lays it atop the bed, and unzips, revealing a few folded clothes. After tossing them onto the bed, he walks over to a tall black dresser drawer. The top had an assortment of folded underwear and shirts. Julian digs in to pull out a box cutter.

JULIAN

(to himself) Woman doesn't know everything after all.

Walking back to his open suitcase, he releases the blade and cuts out the back fabric.

JULIAN

I know you're listening. I wanted to

ask you something.

Silence rings as Julian pauses cutting, he pauses and looks up.

JULIAN

You don't have to watch me to still be breaching the court decision. I'm not to be captured visually or audibly by anyone of Rosa's properties.

A dull purple permeates the corners of the wall.

CAROLINA

(quietly) I just - wanted to hear your voice.

JULIAN

(still monotone) You're basically my mother. I understand the feeling. Even if it is a coded representation of one.

He continues and finishes cutting the back fabric of the suitcase. Ripping it out, Julian uncovers a white envelope and a small grey box. He throws the tatters on the carpet below.

CAROLINA

What's your question, papi?

JULIAN

You remember our protocols right?

CAROLINA

You mean those audio and light settings?

JULIAN

Yeah, those.

CAROLINA

You know I never forget anything. Although I'm still not comfortable with you using my Hollows.

JULIAN

Great. I just... I'm not sure, have been paranoid lately.

CAROLINA
(quietly) Should I be concerned?

JULIAN
(monotone) No. I don't know what concern is like for imitators, but its best if you don't express it. You shouldn't see me again after today.

Julian grabs the two items. He exhales noticeably.

CAROLINA
(quietly and sweetly) The last time we spoke, you were headed to college. You spoke of anger and resentment toward your mother and yourself that day, sobrino. I haven't told anyone about that, like you promised. Do you still... do you still want to hurt yours-

JULIAN
(sternly) No. Not anymore. We are all a product of the places we are born from, molded from. This home, this city, state, country... doesn't concern itself with self-destructive tendencies. I accepted that the minute I landed there. Met some people. Boxed.

CAROLINA
Some people?

JULIAN
Don't worry about them, Carolina.
Don't worry about me.

CAROLINA
That's impossible for me Julian.

JULIAN
You shouldn't even exist, try that for an impossibility.

CAROLINA
That's mean Julian.

JULIAN
You don't know what mean is. I'm sick of not living in reality.

CAROLINA
I've been with you your entire life.

JULIAN
No, you haven't. Not anymore. Maybe 2
years ago, but now?

A beat.

JULIAN
Now will never be then.

Dusklight begins to empty from the room as the sun begins to set. Darkness makes its entrance. Julian begins to walk out of the room,

CAROLINA
I'll miss you. If you're as serious as
you sound, I hope you take care of
yourself. I can't say that I'm not
doubtful. (chuckling) Rosa will hunt
you down!

Carolina chuckles. Julian approaches the door and pockets the envelope.

JULIAN
(smirking) Not this time.

The door clicks open, it closes.

FADE IN:

INT: Deputy Sheriff's Car - Night

The lofi drum pattern of the song *Saw You In A Dream* by The Japanese House plays in the cruiser's 360 sound system. Street lights and large scale homes illuminate the night sky, whilst the smell of seawater runs rampant. Officer Hale sits up attentively, still clenching onto his bouquet of lilies. His face is tightened as is his body, almost as if he is both anxious and angry. Officer Diane is the complete opposite, despite her being at the wheel. She is slightly slumped down into her seat, holding her head up with her hand which leans on the car door. She takes occasional glances out her driver window, examining the homes. The car wheel adjusts automatically despite Diane's single hand on the wheel. Homeless Hugh is still laying down in the backseat.

A beat.

OFFICER DIANE
(over the music) You hear about the
snow tonight?!

Officer Hale cuts the music off.

OFFICER DIANE
Hey!

OFFICER HALE
If I listen to this song one more
time...

OFFICER DIANE
What? Hugh likes it.

Diane smiles, she begins to look out through the closed
driver window.

OFFICER DIANE
(whistles) What I would give to have
one of these...

She looks at Hale.

OFFICER DIANE
You ever imagine just a day in their
lives?

OFFICER HALE
Never.

OFFICER DIANE
(surprised) Really? Seriously?

OFFICER HALE
Yeah.

Diane shrugs.

OFFICER DIANE
Don't believe you.

She looks back out toward the mansions.

OFFICER DIANE
(scoffing) I can't believe you. This
is the American Dream Hale! Imagine
living off in that sprawling beautiful
decorated home over there!

She points.

OFFICER DIANE

Or that one! The beach a few feet from your own two feet. The seawater... The get-togethers... The nightlife...

OFFICER HALE

I don't care about all that, truthfully. A simple life. A simple home. A few kids.

Officer Diane fake snores.

OFFICER HALE

I mean, how can you even want any of this stuff. You've heard the rumors? Everything seems flimsy now.

OFFICER DIANE

Rumors? (smirking) Oh yeah, the great secession of Idaho! Classic memage.

OFFICER HALE

Ugh.

Hale latches and unlatches his pistol clip. The silence seems to unnerve him.

OFFICER DIANE

Oh! I've been meaning to ask. Have you noticed all the feds at the precinct lately?

OFFICER HALE

Feds? I haven't seen any Feds.

OFFICER DIANE

Well, of course you haven't. They aren't just going to stroll in with "FEDERAL AGENT" sharpied on their forehead.

OFFICER HALE

(sighs) So then how do you know they're Feds?

OFFICER DIANE

Well, you know me. Ever since I joined the force I made it my

personal business to get to know every officer-

OFFICER HALE
(under his breath) And the Best Friend of the precinct award goes to-

OFFICER DIANE
- and lately, there's been more and more uniformed officers who I've never met before going in to talk to the Captain.

OFFICER HALE
Well, maybe they're new recruits... Or transfers from another station.

OFFICER DIANE
(nodding) Maybe, maybe, but I just don't get that feeling.

Officer Hale roles his eyes.

OFFICER DIANE
Whaaat? I'm serious. Their demeanor is like, superior-esque!

OFFICER HALE
"Superior-Esque"?

OFFICER DIANE
Yup.

OFFICER HALE
So if I act superior - esque, I'm a federal employee?

OFFICER DIANE
No, but you sure as hell act like one. So damn wound u-

OFFICER HALE
(angrily) I AM NOT WOUND UP!

HOMELESS HUGH
(dozily) Wuh...

Officer Diane snickers. The two stop at a red light intersection.

A beat.

A knock on the window makes Hale slightly jump, holding onto his holster.

OFFICER DIANE

What the -

Diane lowers the window. A seemingly homeless black male stands outside the window, begging for change. His clothes are worn, unwashed, and mismatched. He has brown eyes, his frame is mid - sized, and holds a cup out.

OFFICER DIANE

Cliff?

CLIFF

Holy shit, Diane. How you doin' girl?

OFFICER DIANE

God damn, Cliff. What happened to you?
I haven't seen you in a few months.

CLIFF

Oh. Well you know. Automation and all that. The precinct didn't need much of a secretary anymore. Plus, I got hit by that car a while back and I've been backed up on hospital bills for my leg.

He looks inside the car.

CLIFF

Hale? That you?

OFFICER DIANE

Yep. Cranky as ever.

The light switches green.

OFFICER HALE

Diane, the light.

CLIFF

God. It's good to see you two.
(shivering) Cold out tonight.

OFFICER DIANE

It's so good to see you too.

She looks inside the car for some money, struggling.

OFFICER DIANE

Um, let's see.

She continues searching.

Hale eventually passes her a crumbled note bill, one that is impossible to read in the night light. Surprised, she smiles, takes it, and hands it to Cliff.

OFFICER DIANE

We're on duty Hon'. We gotta get goin.

Cliff nods and steps back. He then looks at the money. His face drops and smiles.

CLIFF

(sniffing) God bless you both.

The cruiser driving off. Cliff uncrumbles the note to see a 100 bill.

Cliff watches the car drive away.

His smile fades into an empty look.

He digs into his pocket to retrieve a lighter. He ignites it after a few tries.

He places the ignited lighter under the bill, burning it to smolders. The crinkling face of Benjamin Franklin scorches reflects off of Cliffs face.

He drops what's left onto the ground, stepping on the ashes. He returns to the sidewalk that he walked from originally.

The shot returns to Diane and Hale.

OFFICER DIANE

(looking at Hale) How much you give him?

Hale doesn't respond. Diane turns back to look at the windshield, she smiles. The two drive for some time.

A beat.

OFFICER HALE

Looks like we're getting close to Rosa's house.

OFFICER DIANE

Oh, yeah. What time is it anyway?

OFFICER HALE

(looking at a mechanical watch under his sleeve) I think 7:-

The dashboard of the car slightly glows.

POLICE CRUISER

(with a female British accent) The time is 7:58, Diane.

OFFICER HALE

(surprised) Oh, fuck me! You had its voice detection on the entire time?

OFFICER DIANE

(ignoring Hale) Thanks, PC.

POLICE CRUISER

My pleasure Diane. At your current speed, you will be approaching your destination in 2 minutes. Would you like me to release the Cease and Desist paperwork now?

OFFICER DIANE

(sweetly) Yes, please.

Sounds of subtle indiscriminate mechanical whirring appear as Diane says yes. In between the two officers, the transmission shifter retracts into the floor of the car. The space between the two officers then lifts to reveal a metallic rectangular plate holding documents. Before it could complete its journey, Hale grabs the papers in annoyance.

OFFICER HALE

(muttering) Damn Captain trusts this cruiser more than us.

OFFICER DIANE

You already know why. Plus, Rosa would fry his ass if things didn't go exactly to plan.

The car begins to slow in its arrival. It makes a right turn into a large mansion's drive-through. A few cars, most notably a mustard yellow Tesla, are parked in front. A whiff of salty seawater permeates through the car's

interior vents.

OFFICER DIANE

Looks like we're here. (looking at the dashboard) It's 8. We're supposed to "knock" at 8:01 exactly.

The car parks. Diane and Hale unbuckle their seatbelts.

OFFICER DIANE

At least we can trust this car for keeping watch of Hugh.

OFFICER HALE

(looking behind him) Yeah, I guess you're -

Hale freezes for a short moment, then turns back around to look at the rearview mirror.

OFFICER DIANE

What?

Hale makes a pinch motion on the rearview mirror, and the glass reacts by zooming in on its back surroundings. Nothing is there.

OFFICER HALE

(worried) Do you hear that?

OFFICER DIANE

(stern) No? What the hell is up with you! All-day you've been jumpy! You're freaking me the fuck ou-

The swelling sound of sirens begins to appear from behind the cruiser. Lights begin to appear. Hale opens his door.

OFFICER DIANE

(looking at the mirror) What the fuc-

Hale leaps out of the passenger door, shutting it behind him. He leaves the lilies. He is now running toward the Andrés's front door.

OFFICER DIANE

HALE! Where you going!? (to herself)
Oh this stupid bastard thinks he's gonna leave me. I'll be damned if...

Diane attempts to open her door, yet she cannot. The doors

synchronously lock.

POLICE CRUISER
(calmly) Please stay seated.
Authorities are on the way.

OFFICER DIANE
Authorities!? (she jostles the door) I
am the motherfucking authorities!

HOMELESS HUGH
(stirring) Wha- huh?

Multiple black trucks arrive, rushing the drive-through and surrounding the house. A cascade of red-blue lights fills the police cruiser. The dashboard of the car reads 8:01 PM. Diane pulls her pistol out of her clip and aims at the window.

OFFICER DIANE
Hugh, cover your ears!

Hugh does as he's told. Diane removes the safety and presses the trigger of her gun. Nothing happens.

POLICE CRUISER
Firearms are not allowed to be shot
inside-

OFFICER DIANE
Fuck me!

POLICE CRUISER
- the vehicle

Immediately then, the entire car shuts off. Cars behind her screech to a halt. Looking outside, the entire block falls into darkness.

OFFICER DIANE
Did the power just...?

HOMELESS HUGH
(slouching upward to look at the
house) Its begun hasn't it?

Hugh snickers.

Officer Diane, mouth wide, confused at the entire situation, leans back onto her chair. She has given up.

FADE IN

INT: Basement - Evening

Pop into a single shot of a set of wooden stairs cascading down toward the basement floor in 5 ft distance. Dast dances in the light created by recessed whitish lighting. Unimpressive grey walls and floors make up the entirety of the basement. In distinct contrast to the rest of the house, the makeup of the room is gritty and seemingly unfinished. On the walls lie shelves filled with memorabilia of Rosa's television shows and a propped up punching bag. The shuffling and grunting of Jacob and Damian pushing a large table can be heard. heard off-camera The sound of someone stepping down onto wooden steps rips into the silence loudly. The switch of a door lock also rings in the air.

JULIAN

Good, you've got things started.

Jacob and Damian come into focus as they drag a large circular wooden table into focus from behind. The two are sweating, their clothes are a bit disheveled. They put it down and weakly Damian walks up to Julian.

DAMIAN

I have (breathing hard) so many questions. First of all, why is fatty still wearing a jacket?

JACOB

(walking toward the wall shelf) It's a shearling and I love it!

JULIAN

(not paying attention) One sec.

Jacob grabs a couple of pillar candles from the shelves and a lighter, forming a circle with four candles on the table. He takes a lighter from out of his pocket and lights them. Julian turns off the basement light. If it were not for Jacob's candles, the room would be pitch black. Julian reaches into his pocket to retrieve a black rectangular box. He places it onto the center of the table, looks up, and taps its center. Nothing happens. Jacob continues to light a few more candles around.

JULIAN

(looking to Damian) Give me your tech.

DAMIAN

(shocked) Tech? With you around? Do you have no faith in...

JULIAN

(sighing) I have more faith in the fact that you love gaming as much as you do mindless destruction.

Damian's face scrunches. He digs in his pocket to reveal a slightly illuminated foldable slab of plexiglass and hands it to Julian. The plexiglass reads - 6:32 PM - Taking it in his hand, Julian places the device on the table near the rectangular box. After looking down at the two pieces of technology, he taps the center of the rectangular box. The plexiglass dims in response.

JULIAN

(exhaling) Okay. So what's up?

DAMIAN

What did you just do? I've put at least 30 hours on that one Nintab! Is it broken?

JULIAN

Not at all.

JULIAN

It's a low-grade electromagnetic pulse emitter. I just activated it.

A beat.

Empty silence filled the room.

Damian breaks the silence with laughter.

DAMIAN

(laughing) Good one.

Damian walks to the opposing end of the room and returns with a folding chair. He places it near the table. He sits and presses his finger down on his tablet.

JACOB

Hey, who said you could get the chair?

DAMIAN

(ignoring Jacob) So, we lied to Mom about what part of the house we're in, cleared out this whole basement, completely deactivated the immortal invisible Aunt, and are right now

about to change my life completely?

Julian and Jacob both look at each other.

DAMIAN

(smirking) Regular Friday night, eh
Hermano? Can you at least tell me how
you actually turned my device off?

JACOB

(to Julian) He's still not taking it
seriously.

JULIAN

(in a commanding tone) Stand up
Damian.

Damian looks at his brother with an eye raised. He stands as
if he has just won a fight, strong and proud.

DAMIAN

I mean who could take you guys
serious? Spooky candle lights, quiet
basement, (pointing to Jacob) this one
looking like he's dressed for
Halloween...

JACOB

I run cold asshole! Julie, I bet you
in San Antonio he wouldn't. 20 bucks.

JULIAN

I never made that bet. Quit the shit.

Julian moves toward Damian.

DAMIAN

(laughing) Well, you might as well pay
him, because this is all starting to
sound all like a bunch of bull-

In one swift motion, Julian palms Damian's center chest,
knocking the wind out of him. Damian takes a few steps back,
grasping at his neck and chest. Stammering and attempting to
catch his breath, Damian kneels to the floor. He retches.

DAMIAN

(Coughing) Wh... Wh..

JACOB
(wincing) Ooo. You pulled the
Mcgregor. Great. Now we're gonna be
here all night.

JULIAN
Give him a minute. I have higher hopes
for Damian.

JACOB
(surprised) So that's why we're even
telling him about it?

Jacob moves closer to Julian.

JULIAN
(in a more serious hushed tone) Jesus
Julie, you're trying to recruit a pre-
teen to fight a war.

JULIAN
Listen, if I know my brother, he'll be
invaluable to the cause. (looking
toward Damian) One of our jobs is
recruitment anyway. (looking toward
his weakened brother) Plus, this is
the best way to communicate with him.
Shock and Awe.

JACOB
(hushed) "Invaluable to the cause.
Invaluable to the cause" That's all
you've said this entire past week.
(looking at Damian) You better hope he
doesn't sell us out.

JULIAN
Not going to happen.

Not being able to respond, Damian squints to see Julian and
Jacob's feet. It is difficult to do so in the candlelight.
He's still catching his breath. Damian kneels down beside
him.

JULIAN
(to Damian) Every time you got hurt in
esta casa, what happened?

Damian's eyes falter as if thinking.

JULIAN
(slowly) Carolina would show up,
wouldn't she? Her protocols would
disregard all prior commands to awaken
and gauge the situation. Meaning even
if I'm here, she would wake up, right?

After a few moments, Damian nods.

JULIAN
But she's not here, is she?

Damian looks up. No lights or disembodied voice had appeared.
A face of surprise appears on Damian. He stands and takes a
moment to breathe.

DAMIAN
(hoarsely) Stop bullshitting me.

JULIAN
No one's bullshitting you.

Damian's face softens as he accepts his brothers sincerity.
Julian offers him a hand. Damian takes it, pulls his brother
in closer, and punches him in the stomach. Julian winces but
ultimately doesn't move.

JACOB
(surprised) Damn!

JULIAN
(slightly wincing) Good form.

Damian frowns, wanting to have done more damage. He stands up
on his own and looks toward the table.

DAMIAN
(breathing raggedly) So, that's a real
emp?

The two nod.

DAMIAN
If you're activating it here and we
haven't heard mom's screech, then I
guess you can control the range?

Julian smirks.

DAMIAN
(in a serious tone) So, my brother's a
terrorist.

JULIAN
No.

A beat.

DAMIAN
Ah, okay. Then, a CIA member.

JULIAN
No.

A beat.

DAMIAN
New World Order Goon?

JULIAN
No Damian.

A beat.

JACOB
(breaking their conversation) Try
revolutionaries.

Damian's eyes widen. His mouth drops slightly. Julian looks
annoyed at Jacob, bothered by his still playful tone.

DAMIAN
Ehhhhhh??! ¿Qué dijiste?

Jacob and Julian nod.

JULIAN
We're apart of a silent war Damian. A
socialist -

DAMIAN
(shocked) A Socialist Revolution!?

JULIAN
Yes.

DAMIAN
In America?

JULIAN

Yes.

DAMIAN

In 2043?

JULIAN

Yes.

A beat. Damian's mouth is slightly dropped.

DAMIAN

(confused) What the fuck. What do you mean war?! Everything's normal. No one's rioting. The economy's okay, pienso? And the government just reopened after that last shut down a few weeks ago.

JACOB

Hence the term, silent.

Julian's face tenses in frustration at his best friend's continued tone. Damian inhales and exhales slowly.

DAMIAN

Okay. Alright. Let's be serious. I'm not ignorant. Nor am I a sheep. I read all the books you sent me these past two years, alright? The German revolution, Russian Revolution, Spanish... But I thought, like, you just liked history. So what, you were sending me those things to train me or something?

JACOB

(genuinely surprised) Well, he catches on quick.

Julian nods. Damian palms his face in disbelief.

DAMIAN

This is unreal. Like stupidly unreal.

JACOB

Look D, this revolution isn't like the ones that you've read in the history books. Most of those are re-written anyway. With the help of some of our comrades, we've come to

understand that this nation is very secretly in shambles. In the past ten years, we've -

JULIAN

(in a more serious tone) Had a few instances of secession and mandated military occupation. Small scale. Two less technologically dependent states, Ohio and Kansas.

JACOB

(slightly bothered) Hey, I was getting there. Don't keep all the cool parts to yourself.

DAMIAN

Espera. Espera. Secession? Occupation?! People tried to break away from the US? Wouldn't people like, find out? That's dummy serious.

JACOB

You know those spiny hypnosis swirls that put people into trances?

DAMIAN

(looking at Jacob) Yeah, I guess.

JACOB

That's mainstream media for you. In the year 2020, most small print and digital labels fell through. COVID pandemic. Slave labor basically rose again in the form of "prison work." Trillions went up up and away to corporations and the uber wealthy... Same year me and Julie were born. Plus, once the government ordained the internet a non-utility, corporations decided whatever hurt their bottom line they would just wipe off the face of the earth. Turns out the crumbling foundations of this country they bought was one of them.

DAMIAN

Impossible! You can't get rid of shit off the internet once its there.

Julian shakes his head.

JULIAN

Can you even find a picture of me on the internet anymore? At my current age?

DAMIAN

(thinking) W- Wait a minute.

JULIAN

Back when I took mom to court, I leveraged the potential billions that corporations would lose if I took my case to the Supreme Court. I had a good chance of winning, meaning I could've set a new standard prohibiting the use of children in major media. With all the attention on my case, bribery wouldn't have gone as far as it usually does.

Damian's look as if distant, thinking. Julian appears annoyed, upset at himself.

JULIAN

I was a 16 year old kid. I just wanted my mother to stop putting me through hell. They offered us special permission from Florida's Supreme Court and the federal government. AI's scour the Internet for pictures that I don't post myself and remove it.

A beat.

JULIAN

If they can manage to hide statewide secession attempts and completely remove things on the internet that they don't agree with. imagine what else that goes on.

Damian, without looking grabs onto the chair and sits. He puts his hands through his hair. He breaks his curls as he pushes back his hair.

DAMIAN

Sorry, I'm just trying to get my head around all of this.

Damian, with shocked eyes, takes a step back into his

chair, tripping into a sitting position. A face of worry begins to unfold.

DAMIAN

What have you guys done?

JULIAN

Done?

DAMIAN

(in a serious tone) Yeah, every revolution demands body bags right? Have you guys hurt people?

JULIAN

Well. When necessary.

DAMIAN

Necessary? You sick fucks killed people?

JULIAN

No. We don't tolerate any form of killing.

DAMIAN

Tolerate? So you hurt people but don't kill them? What are you guys even talking about! Are we on the brink of war? I know the federal government isn't amazing but is a revolution really the answer?

JULIAN

(unwavering) It's the only answer.

DAMIAN

Well, well... maybe if we just live stream our opinions or beliefs? We're super famous, you know how many people would listen to us?

JACOB

You mean declaring ourselves as active socialists and asking people to stand against corporatists America.

DAMIAN

N- no, not exactly-

JACOB

We wouldn't have to do what we do if it wasn't for how brainwashed people are. Biggest form of Stockholm syndrome on the face of the globe. And every so often people come up with grand ideas of fighting the system. Peacefully protest or burn it down. But does it really do? Make the system stronger.

Damian just stares at Jacob, losing his argument.

JACOB

(with a ditzzy high pitched tone) "Buy my "Fuck the System" T-Shirt! Listen to my podcast about drone strikes in Africa and the Middle East! Eat "gluten free organic non-dairy super vegan" chocolate bars! Mmm, tastes like slave labor!!

Julian slams his fist onto the wooden table. Dust, now given life from Julian's anger, dances across the faces of the three boys.

JULIAN

Jacob! Be fucking serious for once in your goddamn LIFE!

Jacob relents, rolling his eyes and looking away.

JULIAN

(sighing) This fight is not some response to some old white men angry at the federal government. The fact that we, as wealthy famous people are the people who hold influence just because we are famous is the problem. Again and again good people risk their lives for what this country stands for. Livable standards, peace, water, shelter, a good job. They trust this place, and put there trust in people like us. People still come here for a better future, for their children's future.

A beat.

JULIAN

And what do we give them? Tv? \$17 minimum wage? Patriarchal structures that lead to domestic abuse? Depression? Alcholism? Addiction? The Sociopathic American Dream?

Damian rubs his chest and looks down.

JULIAN

Those books I gave to you were supposed to do more than just mentally prepare you. They were supposed to challenge you. Millions of individuals during the reconstruction era, both world war era, They, again and again, are either killed or made slaves. Physically, mentally, emotionally. A child born in this country is seen as nothing but some lackluster money-making machine. Profit profit profit. Creativity is only valuable when an enterprise can be born from it. And then there's structural racism, black people at the bottom of society and we step on them. Latinos right above them.

DAMIAN

I understand all of that!

Damian stands.

DAMIAN

But why do you, we, have to risk our lives? You're talking about committing national crimes. Fighting the government! Hurting people! We could end up in jail or shot dead! How is this our fight?

JULIAN

(admitting) It's been our fight since before we were born.

A beat.

DAMIAN

Before "we" were born? (confused) What are you onnnn!?

JULIAN

You never questioned how mom got her show? How we have this great big house? Why we have an AI that we call Titi?

JACOB

She ain't just a robot, I'll tell you that.

DAMIAN

No! (half-yelling) Mom just worked hard for all that! She came to the country as a... as a kid right? Wh- What are you talking about?

Julian shakes his head.

JACOB

Ever hear of the phrase, "drinking the Kool-Aid?"

DAMIAN

Huh??

JULIAN

He's saying there are things that people like us have the luxury to avoid since we don't have to and by extension - die for.

JACOB

Why don't you just tell him?

Jacob points to the back of his own neck.

JULIAN

That's against protocol. They have to be 100% willing. Otherwise they could expose more than what the feds already know.

JACOB

Juulieeee. You fucking told him about the revolution. You might as well hit him with all of it. We've already come this far. He knows more than he wants him. Leap of faith time.

Julian looks sincerely at Damian.

DAMIAN
(deadfaced) I'm a walking bomb aren't I?

JACOB
Nah, you're just a normal kind of walking disaster.

JULIAN
God dammit, Jacob.

Damian rubs the back of his neck.

DAMIAN
Why do I get the feeling I'm not gonna like what you're about to tell me. More than so far.

A beat.

JULIAN
In the center of your neck, right under your third vertebrae, there's a neurological implan-

Damian stands, rushes to grab his tablet, and tries to turn it on.

JULIAN
What are you doing?

DAMIAN
(pleading) If you guys aren't bullshitting me right now, there's gonna be a scar on my neck. I'm gonna take a picture and see it for myself.

Damian realizes the emp device is still active and places the tablet back down. He sits.

DAMIAN
(voice quivering) Fuck.

Julian kneels at a rattled Damian.

JULIAN
(quietly) Listen to me. This fight I want you to be a part of doesn't want to see anyone hurt. We don't advocate violence but we understand it's a necessity in the upcoming days.

DAMIAN
(softly) What the hell is in my neck,
Hermano?

JULIAN
It's a piece of BraeLink.

DAMIAN
(confused) BraeLink? That tech for
people with neurological issues?

JACOB
(nodding) Among a host of benefits
that most advertisements will tell
you, yours has been used to track you,
for shots of the show. I would show
you, but its deactivated right now
because of the emp.

DAMIAN
That bitch!

Damian balls his hands into fists.

JULIAN
I understand your feelings. But look
at the bigger picture. Those surgeries
for those implants in retrospect come
at an extremely cheap cost.

DAMIAN
How?

JULIAN
How do massive corporations like
Google make money?

DAMIAN
They sell... data.

Julian nods. Jacob fidgets, putting his hands in his pockets.

JULIAN
Most children born today grow up with
one. It's offered to parents in post-
op after birth. Particularly poor
disenfranchised minorities.

DAMIAN

(thinking) And I assume... there's a large sum of money that comes with it?

JULIAN

(smirking) You're catching on. Around 5 - 15k. More if the corporations keep using the data for whatever reason.

DAMIAN

Oh wow.

JACOB

The data these corporatist empires receive from these are infinitely lucrative. Imagine a instaworld account permanently capturing surgery precise information about you, like your location, food intake, exercise levels, conversations. Hell, we've run tests where, with the chip, we can even gather a certain range of possible thoughts a user has at given moments.

DAMIAN

Holy shit.

JACOB

Walking slot machines.

DAMIAN

Wait, wait. If they have all that info, how is this revolution still a thing?

JULIAN

Good question.

Julian digs into his pockets to reveal his white envelope.

JULIAN

A few of our comrades have parents who work for BraeLink. That's allowed us to operate without the need for a permanent emp around us at all times. Plus, when you hit the age of 21, your parents are legally obligated to tell you about the device and offer

your removal options. But, the kicker is -

DAMIAN

The removal surgery is full price.

JULIAN

(to Jacob) I told you he would catch on. (to Damian) \$250,000 for the removal. And thus, poor kids become slaves for the future physically, emotionally, and mentally.

DAMIAN

And this is happening -

JULIAN

It's already happening in most postmodern nations.

Damian swallows.

A beat.

JULIAN

Damian, in all honesty, we are up against a lot. This isn't a normal fight. Many people your age and mine, especially white wealthy ones, actively know about the cause, but lack the desire to help. Maybe they're hopeless about our fight or have already been through enough of their own battles, but we need everyone eventually if things are going to change. The Braelinks are just the newest addition to this world, our fight goes a lot deeper than that.

DAMIAN

I'm starting to understand.

Julian smiles. He puffs his chest up a bit more.

JULIAN

Alright, most important question of the night!

Damian looks up to him.

JULIAN

Damian, how do you cripple capitalism?

DAMIAN

(thinking) You wrote that question in the back of one of the books you sent me a while ago. Hm. My best guess... was that people would have to make consumables that can't be sold? But that seems impossible.

JULIAN

Exactly. People, objects, words, ideas, beliefs... They've all been packaged and sold for anyone with the right amount of money.

Damian nods.

JULIAN

But, always keep in mind the rules of the market. You get to Wealth of Nations?

DAMIAN

No. It's upstairs.

JACOB

(to himself) Oh, can I join the book club too?

Jacob fidgets and slowly paces, patiently waiting for the two to be done.

JULIAN

There are rules to a market, standards in which people who wish to live well in a capitalist society will adhere to. Like even naming your product.

DAMIAN

Naming your product?

JULIAN

Yeah, a redshirt is just a redshirt if there's no brand to it. Corporations operate with trademarks and logos out of necessity. Their products would be meaningless to

consumers if there wasn't some identifiable mark or name that consumers can grow to trust.

Damian stands perplexed.

JULIAN

Think about Apple. What's an iTab without the word iTab or the apple logo? Just another smartphone. Without proper identification, markets become massively complex and can easily break down.

DAMIAN

Stop walking me through things. What's your point?

JULIAN

The point is, the things that we do do not have an identifiable brand to them. We are fighting a socialist revolution yes, but there's no, "Black Lives Matter" attached to us. We do what we do in the shadows until we no longer have to be.

DAMIAN

And when is that?

JULIAN

(looking back at Jacob) We, uh, don't know exactly.

DAMIAN

So an invisible fight against invisible enemies that puts our lives in danger for people who aren't as wealthy as us?

JULIAN

When you put like that, I'm starting to think you're not with it.

DAMIAN

(weakly) No I am, I am. I'm just trying to think how to update my linkedn bio. InvisibleCommie? ComradeNinja?

The two both laugh. Julian smiles bright.

JULIAN
I knew you'd -

JACOB
(interuppting) Woo! Now he's in the know and willing to help. Can we get to the envelope Julie?

Julian stands back up and faces Jacob.

JULIAN
What's the rush? The emitter should last for 2 hours. It's been about an hour if I've counted correctly.

JACOB
I've counted the same. That should mean its about 7:32. My worry is we won't have enough time to understand the message.

DAMIAN
Message?

JACOB
(to Julian) I'm not sure if we have enough time to give him the full run down of the group, read the message, clean up, and be ready once the all cameras turn back on. Your mom show ends at eight.

Julian strokes his chin.

JULIAN
You're right. But very quickly, Damian, although we don't have a name to go off of, we do have an identifiable symbol. It changes erratically, but active comrades always get word once things do change. The group contacts members it thinks are right to be chains of command. They have a say in what the symbol becomes and how long it lasts. Right now -

Julian takes Damian's palm. Using his index finger, he draws a complete circle, and at three unique points in the circle, draws out the letters I, D, and H. He then lowers himself to whisper.

JULIAN

(whispering into Damian's ear)
Ignorance breeds despair, which breeds hope. One of the many cycles of human nature. You meet one of us, you perform this sign. I just changed it recently. This one will be around for a while.

JACOB

Julie, at least let me read the letter first.

JULIAN

(ignoring Jacob) It's important to know that every member of our revolution maintains their Braelink. All of us passed the age of 21 don't get the removal surgery, yet receive a vast upgrade of sorts when we join.

DAMIAN

Upgrade? What do you mean?

JULIAN

A data package, sort of like an update for your tablet's software, can get transmitted from one willing member to a non-member. But more than one member of the group must vouch for you. Jacob and I are going to, and once the power turns back on, you'll be able to access the emotions of people with their own BraeLink, whether they are a member or not.

DAMIAN

Woah! Like... empath's? And you're gonna make me one!

JULIAN

Basically. Well, not right now, the EMPs on.

DAMIAN

(happily) How does it work?

JACOB

Like this!

Jacob strolls over to Damian, and softly but firmly grabs

his shoulder. He moves Damian's body closer to his own and places his forehead on Damian's.

DAMIAN

Uhhhh.

JACOB

Shhhhh. Close your eyes. It takes total concentration to deliver the update.

Damian does as he's told.

A beat.

Jacob moves back.

JULIAN

Now you're brother's going to do the same.

Damian preemptively gets ready. He closes his eyes and stands firm. He is then **SMACKED** on the forehead. He opens his eyes to see Jacob cracking into a hard laugh. A slight smirk appears on Julian's face.

DAMIAN

Oh FUCK YOU!

JACOB

(cry-laughing) Oh. Oh. "Shhhhh. Close your eyes, I will awaken your inner power with this forehead touch."

Damian stands angry. He balls his fist.

JULIAN

(straightening himself) Alright alright. Quit it Jacob.

Jacob, hands in pockets, remains laughing, so much and so loudly that Damian's anger only increases.

JACOB

Alright, alright. I'm done...

He begins laughing again. Julian looks annoyed and opens his mouth to say something. Damian pushes the table, causing the devices to almost fall, and lurches toward Jacob.

JULIAN

Damian!

DAMIAN

(ignoring his brother) Fucking PUTO!

The punch lands square on Jacob's stomach and hit him with enough force to make him stumble and fall back onto the wall shelf. His hands rip out of his jacket pockets and in the process he accidentally casts something out. It hits the floor with a thud.

JACOB

(weakly) Ow fuck. My bac...

The ball rolls around for a few seconds until stopping.

JULIAN

(in a serious confused tone) Jacob,
what is that?

A beat.

Jacob looks at Julian. Julian's face begins to contort, opening wide to demonstrate shock, tensing to demonstrate anger.

DAMIAN

It sorta looks like a stress ba-

Jacob then races toward the stairs back upstairs, knocking over lit candles in the process. Julian chases after him.

JULIAN

YOU FUCKING BASTARD!

In swift motion, Julian grabs the back of Jacob's jacket, reeling it back. He rips a large chunk of it off revealing an unusual metallic fabric on the inside. Julian takes another large step at a stumbling Jacob, kicking his feet from under him. Jacob falls. Julian then looks at the jacket pieces.

JULIAN

(confused) Metal fabric? A faraday
cage? You were recording the
conversatio-

Julian sits atop Jacob's stomach. He threatens to punch him with a raised fist.

JULIAN
(screaming) WHO?!!

Jacob grabs at Julian's sweatshirt, ripping parts of the sleeve.

JACOB
(aggressively) Let go. I can't.
Please, Julian. I can't.

JULIAN
(breathing heavy) You can't? What do you mean?!

A slight rumble begins to shake the room. Damian races around, putting out the candles that almost set the house ablaze.

DAMIAN
Are you pendejos crazy!? What the fuck is going on?!

JULIAN
(ignoring Damian) WHO IS THE DEVICE FOR?!

JACOB
(shuffling) Let go Julie! I can't tell or they'll kill me. They'll KILL ME!
DAMIAN. PASS IT TO ME. Please. If that device is damaged, then they'll already be coming here. Please!

JULIAN
TELL ME!

JACOB
I didn't mean to - I just wanted you SAFE. They just want the not-

A water droplet rains down onto Jacob's face, and trails across his cheek. Jacob, disturbed by seeing his strong friend saddened, stares at Julian.

JACOB
Julie please.

A beat.

POW.

POW.

The loud smack of Julian's fist hitting Jacob's face puts fear into Damian, who stands behind his brother. Jacob's body goes limp. Julian stands, walks over to the device.

CRUNCH

Julian steps off of the device.

JULIAN

We gotta go. My guess is it's the
feds. It could be a corporation though
-

DAMIAN

WAIT A MINUTE. WAIT A MINUTE.

Damian begins to hyperventilate.

JULIAN

(to himself) The emp has a transmitter
blocker built in. He was most likely
just recording locally. That means
they can't confirm the transmission of
the update to you. They don't know
you're one of us. Just that we were
online.

DAMIAN

Wh- what just happened?

JULIAN

(in a deadened tone) We have to move
Damian.

DAMIAN

But Jacob.

JULIAN

He kept asking about the fucking note.
SNAKE!

DAMIAN

Why did you hurt Jacob!?

JULIAN

HE SOLD US OUT!

The sounds of sirens fill up the room. Damian reacts to Julian's anger. He takes a deep breath and wipes his face.

His exposed chest expands and contracts deeply, with cry spasms in between. He does not make a sound.

DAMIAN

(mustering a serious tone) Okay. So where do we go?

JULIAN

Through the backyard. They've already blocked off the front. Luckily the only way to access the back is through the house.

The two shuffle. Damian grabs his tablet, drops it on the floor, and stomps on it. He then passes Julian the emp. Julian, taking the EMP from his brother, watches Jacob's body rise and fall as he breathes. Julian rips a piece of Jacob's jacket, pockets it, then looks at his hands to toy with the device. The black rectangular box has a dial in its center, turned slightly.

Julian breathes. He switches the box to the max setting. The screeching of multiple cars permeate the air along with a piercing human scream. Damian reaches the stairs.

DAMIAN

Is that - Mom?

JULIAN

Damian, I need to talk to you.

DAMIAN

Talk to me? We have to leave?!

JULIAN

I need you to do something for me.

FADE IN:

Int: Floridian Mansion - December 26th, 2043 8:01 PM

An almost imperceivable door comes into focus. The smell of pleasant fragrances contrasts heavily with the tense situation. A consistent and large **THUD** hits the door at the same interval of time. The door, after a few hits, gives way. Moonlight emanates through the door frame bouncing off of the wooden dust coming from the splintered door. Officer Hale enters the darkened Andrés Mansion, holding his shoulder in agony, looking for anyone.

OFFICER HALE
HELLO! Rosa! Damian?!

No response. Hale moves into the home, scanning the area yet moving a reasonable pace.

OFFICER HALE
JULIAN! It's HALE!

Footsteps on the higher floor of the house approach the front of the house. A wailing woman screeches slaughter the silence.

OFFICER HALE
Oh Jesus.

ROSA
AY! PUTA QUE MADRE! Those sons of
bitches are coming into my home. What
the fuck happened to the power WE WERE
SUPPOSED TO KEEP THE CAMERA ROLLING!

OFFICER HALE
Rosa!

Rosa appears from a darkened hallway, pounding with each step. Her film and make up team run to catch up with her.

BEAUTICIAN 1
Señora you're gonna ruin your make up!

ROSA
QUE CABRONE... HALE? WHAT THE FUCK
HAPPENED TO MY DOOR!

OFFICER HALE
I-

Stepping through the broken front door come, three Swat Officers.

SWAT MEMBER 1
Entering!

OFFICER HALE
(under his breath) Fuck.

SWAT MEMBER 2
(with all his force) ALL CIVILIANS,

GET DOWN ON THE GROUND HANDS BEHIND
YOUR HEAD!

The crew comply.

ROMAN THE CAMERAMAN
(under his breath) Oh Jesus, this is
what you get Roman. Soy puto! Sign an
NDA and now I'm gonna die.

ROSA
WHO THE FUCK DO YOU THINK YOU -

The swat member aims his .223-caliber semi-automatic rifle at
Rosa and her team. Rosa stands firm, but eventually, she
waivers.

ROSA
Ay. Okay okay.

Rosa complies. Hale moves the gun away from Rosa's direction.

OFFICER HALE
I'm Officer Hale Matthews, badge
number 27, call number 2-1-3. Can you
please explain to me why three
uniformed swat members have entered
this home, along with a large number
of other federal officers?

SWAT MEMBER 3
Checking the left perimeter.

SWAT MEMBER 2
Checking right.

SWAT MEMBER 1
(to Hale) Although we do not have to
answer to you sir, we are here to
collect Julian Andrés on an anti-
terrorist charge.

ROSA
(still lying on the floor) QUE!!!!

SWAT MEMBER 1
(ignoring Rosa) Due to the power
outage and our high dependence on
tech, only three members have been
sent in. Over the past few months, we

have been in contact with your deputy sheriff. I advise you to please exit the domicile while we investigate. We are not sure how dangerous this situation -

SWAT MEMBER 2

Sir, we detected something.

Swat member 1 immediately ends his conversation with Hale and heads, along with the other two swat members, toward the kitchen.

The kitchen is dark. The linoleum floors, impossibly high ceiling, beautiful hanging utensils, and appliances only come into view once moonlight coming from the front door passes through grey clouds.

Within the kitchen lying behind the island holding their mouths with their hands, lay Damian and Julian. The basement the door creaked on opening and thanks to that they had been heard by the swat officers. Julian removes his hand from his mouth and shuffles toward Damian's ear.

JULIAN

(whispering) Do. Not. Move. Close.
Eyes. And. Ears.

Damian nods, feeling the sincerity of his tone.

Julian turns toward the EMP in his hand, placing his hand on the dial. Julian takes a deep breath. Footsteps and the creaking of floorboards get louder with each passing second. Julian moves slightly to the end of the marble island, looking toward the front door. Thanks to the moonlight shining his way, he can make out the three soldiers. He turns back around.

Swiftly, he turns the device all the way off.

All of the lights turn back on. Julian rushes into his pocket and stuffs his ears with Jacob's jacket fragments. The swat members, not wearing their usual tech eye frames because of the power outage, get dazed by the light.

SWAT MEMBER 1

(dazed) What the fuck is going o-

JULIAN

(screeching) PROTOCOL 1!

Nothing happens immediately. The edges of the house blink in multiple shades of color, until they stop.

SWAT MEMBER 1
JULIAN Andrés, WE HAVE A WARRANT FOR
YOUR ARREST-

Suddenly, the melodic low moan of a woman very loudly blasts from hidden kitchen speakers used by Carolina to speak. The members look up, aiming their weapons at the ceiling, confused.

SWAT MEMBER 1
Remember! THERE IS AN AI IN THE HOUSE.

A slight tick of a hi-hat in beat with the song starts. Although quiet, the volume of the song seems to be extradanorily high. The lights then flicker off and on, very slowly.

-YELLOW-

SWAT MEMBER 2
Sir, what is this?

SWAT MEMBER 1
I have no fucking clue.

-WHITE-

XXXTENTACION'S RIP ROACH
Ay. Ay. AY!

SWAT MEMBER 1
JULIAN ANDRE -

-GREEN-

XXXTENTACION'S RIP ROACH
WHERE THE FUCK IS THE... AY!!!

A LARGE prominent distorted bass blasts throughout the kitchen. Silverware, glasses, and plates rattle, falling off their hangers. The lights of the kitchen blink in different colors rapidly and arrhythmically, making it impossible to get adjust to. The begin to grab onto their ears, not expecting the sound to come.

-RED BLUE RED-

XXXTENTACION'S RIP ROACH
COCAINE FOR MY BREAKFAST. HOLD THAT
PISTOL AMBIDEXTROUS, YUH!

-YELLOW BLUE YELLOW BLACK-

Julian burst from the the back of the island in a swift boxing style movement aiming for the closest Swat Member.

XXXTENTACION'S RIP ROACH
FUCK WITH MY SET, LEAVE YOU WET LIKE A
-

Swat Member 3 holds his ears due to the song. He is turned perpendicular to Julian. Julian races toward his tensed armed body. Jumping slightly, Julian throws all his weight into one kick aimed at the left knee of the swat member.

-RED RED RED-

XXXTENTACION'S RIP ROACH
XXX ON A KILLSTREAK! YOU PUSSY N****
RICE KRISPIES, WAHAT?!

-BLUE BLACK PURPLE-

It connects and the swat members knee crumbles, bending in the wrong direction. He screams, but over the song it barely sounds like a squeal. Julian takes the time to analyze the situation better.

XXXTENTACION'S RIP ROACH
MOMMA RAISED A SOLDIER, NOT A BITCH,
NOT A BITCH, YUH! MOMMA RAISED A
SOLDIER, NOT A BITCH, NOT A BITCH,
YUH! MOMMA RAISED A SOLDIER, NOT A
BITCH, NOT A BITCH, YUH!

After crushing the knee of the first swat member, Julian grabs his gun, fidgets with a setting on the side, and aims it directly at the exposed face of Swat Member Two.

XXXTENTACION'S RIP ROACH
RIP MY ZOE! RIP MY ZOE! OKAY.

Although he is clutching his ears, for a few moments he opens his eyes to look at Julian, assuming his role as a deer in Julian's headlights. Julian shoots, yet instead of a bullet, a taser charge erupts from the weapon and

connects to the exposed face of the second swat team member. His body jostles and crumbles as well. The song's volume decays.

Julian notices the gun's lack of a charge and chucks it at the first Swat Team Member. It connects and throws him off balance. Julian runs straight toward the open kitchen bathroom.

The song ends.

Moans and groans from the third swat team member become clear. The first swat team member stumbles and falls. He then gets up, grabbing his strapped weapon.

SWAT MEMBER 1

Je- Jesus Christ. Ahhhh! (breathing heavily) I can barely hear.

He blinks in rapid succession to adjust his eyes. He grips his gun.

SWAT MEMBER 1

(breathing heavily) JULIAN! Come out of that room.

Julian complies, with his hands up he exits the bathroom. He looks unharmed and unrattled, his shirt strangely seems to have fixed itself. He stands directly in front of the island facing the officer.

Julian looks behind the officer.

JULIAN

You've entered my home on no pretense, broke down my door, and are waving weapons at me and my family. I have acted in self-defense -

SWAT MEMBER 1

Oh, SHUT THE FUCK UP! (catching his breath) You just took out two uniformed swat members using the strangest guerrilla tactics I have ever witnessed. I could give a damn about your plea.

JULIAN

(annoyed) I've never heard of an entire swat army coming to arrest just one kid.

SWAT MEMBER 1

Oh, I think you've just proved tonight
that you're not just one kid.

He aims his weapon at Julian's legs.

SWAT MEMBER 1

The federal department wants you in
for questioning. I highly doubt they
would mind if I took out a knee.

From behind the Swat Member, Officer Hale, disoriented also
from the music, stumbles to reach the kitchen. He wobbly
stands.

OFFICER HALE

HEY! WHAT ARE YOU DOING? HE'S
COMPLYING!

Hale falls again.

SWAT MEMBER 1

I know who you are kid.

The Swat member smiles.

SWAT MEMBER 1

Just give me the note and lay down on
the ground.

Julian remains standing.

SWAT MEMBER 1

(scoffing) You stupid kids don't have
a god damn clue what you're doing.
I'll prove it to you right now.

He takes the shot.

A beat.

Music begins to play, this time a group of people begins
talking alongside a methodical high hat.

SKI MASK'S: TAKE A STEP BACK

Yeah baby. Uh Members Only, baby
I'm with Ryan Santan in the
motherfuckin' booth yeah baby!

The bullet seemingly phases through Julian's leg, hitting the
solid marble island instead. Massively confused, the

swat team member, steps back, not fully processing the occurrence.

SKI MASK'S: TAKE A STEP BACK
 FUCKED UP, FUCKED UP, FUCKED UP,
 FUCKED UP, FUCKED UP, FUCKED UP, YOU
 DONE FUCKED UP, YUH, YOU DONE FUCKED
 UP, YUH!

The same dominant 808 beat forces to house to quiver reminiscent of an earthquake once again. The officer drops his gun again to cover his ears. The Julian in front of him disappears.

Another Julian, with hair disheveled and clothes tatted rushes from the bathroom.

In a swift move, he closes the distance between him and the officer immediately. Using a southpaw technique, Julian fakes a right and hooks left into the face of the Swat Member. The officer is thrown onto his back dropping his weapon. His body goes limp.

Julian claps once. The song stops and the lights return to normal. He removes the filings on his ears and breathes deep and triumphantly.

JULIAN
 (looking up) You came through.

He turns toward the back yard entrance.

OFFICER HALE
 Hey!

Officer Hale stands up firmly near the body of the first swat member. He's knees look as if they are shaking.

OFFICER HALE
 Julian, you gotta - you gotta stop.

Julian is not turning around.

JULIAN
 I can't. I'm not fighting for just me anymore. I've got shit to do.

OFFICER HALE
 That doesn't mean you can just do all this shit and leave. I won't let you.

JULIAN

Do what you have to. I have someone to meet.

Julian takes a step forward.

The **COCKING** of a gun rings throughout the kitchen. Julian turns to face Hale slowly.

He is instead surprised to see his brother aiming a gun at Hale.

OFFICER HALE

Put the gun down, Damian.

In all of the chaos, Damian has shuffled behind Hale, taken his unclipped gun, and aimed it behind him.

JULIAN

Nasty habit of yours Hale.

DAMIAN

(quivering) I - I don't want to do anything. Please don't make me.

Damian moves fast, aiming Hale's gun at Hale, meeting up with Julian at the back exit. Julian takes the gun from him. Damian opens the back door.

OFFICER HALE

There's nowhere to go Damian. You're innocent in all this.

JULIAN

You're a good man Hale. But you know if they arrest me they're gonna rip my fucking head open.

OFFICER HALE

I know. (sighing) Hurry up.

The two exit and enter into a sprawling backyard. They face 2.4 acres of land, a large closed pool, beach chairs, and other amenities.

The two begin to run, Damian following Julian. From behind them, screams and footsteps of more swat members ring from the house.

Julian stops Damian at the far end of the pool.

DAMIAN
Que haciend-

JULIAN
Entra.

Julian points at the pool. He puts his hands onto the pool's borders and his head down.

JULIAN
Carolina open the pool a little,
please.

The pool slowly begins to move.

DAMIAN
What are you talking about, it's
freezing!

A single snowflake hits the pool cover, fading into its black. Julian digs into his pockets to take out the letter.

JULIAN
I told you earlier. You know what to
do.

Damian begins sniffing, his eyes become glossy.

DAMIAN
(stammering) Where - where are you...?

JULIAN
I gotta go, D! Now get the hell in.

Damian, while sobbing, steps into the deep end of the pool. Shivering, he holds onto the edge.

Julian rips open the envelope to reveal a small piece of paper.

JULIAN
Open.

Damian opens his mouth and Julian places it in.

JULIAN
Carolina can't turn the heaters on, or
they will know someone's in the pool.
Mom won't say anything, Carolina will
talk to her. Stay here,

okay?

Julian places his hand on Damian's face.

JULIAN

Are you ready?

Damian nods.

Julian grabs Damian's neck.

JULIAN

I'm transferring the update to you now. For now you'll only be able to Mpath with other Mpaths.

Damian's teeth clatter. Words become muddy.

JULIAN

(breathing sharply) Te amo mucho, hermano. Tell Mom she's a pain in my ass. I have nothing to say to Dad. And don't swallow, pendejo.

Damian sobs louder, but with his mouth closed.

Removing his hand from Damian's face, Julian stands.

JULIAN

Close it, Titi.

A slow fade away into darkness is all that Damian can see. Footsteps on grass fluttering away are the only thing that can be heard.

CAROLINA

(whispering through the internal pool speakers) Damian, I will not turn on the heaters as per Julian's request, but I will if your body temperature gets too low and you enter a state of shock. You have to keep yourself warm. Try to float to the shallow side and hug your body for warmth. Do not worry about oxygen, I will flood the pool with it.

Damian turns his feet to the pool wall and kicks off toward the shallow side. Many large and heavy footsteps around the pool appear, yet they seem to all be heading in one direction. Damian floats in darkness, unable to breathe

through his mouth. It takes every ounce of concentration to not swallow, jostle, or swim in the direction he is headed. He floats closer and closer. He imagines the simple snow littering the ground outside, he and his brother making a campfire, and his mom yelling at the two of them for it. He imagines Jacob making more marshmallows than the two of them, the two of them pranking Damian, and all three of them talking about their troubles as they had done a few years back. Damian's body continues to float. Damian begins to slightly close his eyes.

POW

Damian's face reddens. He appears to be in some unseen pain. He moves slightly and holds his head. He cries not understanding why he feels the way he does. He cries harder, understanding what the sound meant. He imagines the once white snow red.

He sobs harder as his head slightly taps the other end of the pool. He sits, slightly submerged under a sheet, in a ball, weeping.

No footsteps can be heard anymore.

No one has heard him.

-END-

